

Chiara Castrovillari

Ph.D. Student in Economics, Cornell University | Ithaca, NY | cc2788@cornell.edu | +1 401 286 5908

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics , Cornell University — Ithaca, NY Started Fall 2023; currently completing the third year of the program as of Spring/Summer 2026.	2023–present
Master of Public Affairs , Brown University, Watson Institute — Providence, RI	2020
BSc in Politics, Philosophy and Economics, major in Economics , University of Warwick — Coventry, UK	2018

WORKING PAPERS AND RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- “What are the Labor Market Effects of U.S. State-Level R&D Tax Credits?”** Working paper.
Studies whether state-level R&D tax credits affect the R&D labor market using staggered adoption across U.S. states and event-study differences-in-differences designs.
Finds that credits increase scientific R&D employment and establishments while having little effect on wages.
- “Location, Career Trajectories, and Entrepreneurial Entry.”** Research in progress.
Uses French administrative panel data linking salaried and self-employed workers to study how location and career histories shape entrepreneurial entry and outcomes.
Develops an empirical strategy to distinguish sorting into cities from the causal effects of accumulated experience across locations and firms.
- “Knowledge Spillovers and Agglomeration in Historical Context.”** Research in progress, with Eleonora Patacchini and Davide M. Coluccia.
Studies knowledge spillovers arising from agglomeration in a historical setting.
Builds machine learning and text-analysis tools to measure spillovers and relatedness across economic activity.

PUBLICATIONS AND POLICY WRITING

- “The Effect of Macroeconomic Shocks on Conflict and Political Instability.”** IMF Working Paper, with Tomohide Mineyama and Patcharaporn Leepipatiboon.
Constructed a panel dataset covering 135 countries and contributed to the empirical strategy and analysis using local projections in R and Stata.
- “Tackling the Global Food Crisis: Impact, Policy Response and the Role of the IMF.”** IMF note / policy analysis; presented at the World Bank–IMF Annual Meetings, 2022.
Main contributor of quantitative analysis on the effects of commodity price increases and terms-of-trade losses on import bills and food insecurity in low-income countries.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Elio Nimier-David , Cornell University — Ithaca, NY Provided research assistance during the third year of the Ph.D. program.	Sep. 2025–May 2026
Teaching Assistant, Introductory Macroeconomics , Cornell University; Arnab Basu — Ithaca, NY	Jan. 2025–May 2025
Teaching Assistant, Introductory Microeconomics , Cornell University; Stephanie Thompson — Ithaca, NY	Aug. 2024–Dec. 2024
Research Assistant, Strategy, Policy and Review Department , International Monetary Fund — Washington, DC Conducted empirical research on conflict, commodity shocks, food insecurity, fragile and conflict-affected countries, and IMF lending using R, Stata, Excel, and macroeconomic/program data. Presented research in internal seminars and contributed quantitative analysis for IMF policy papers and notes.	Aug. 2020–Aug. 2023
Consultant, Poverty and Equity Global Strategy Group , World Bank — Washington, DC Harmonized survey data for 18 Sub-Saharan African countries and created variables measuring digital technology uptake using R. Produced a codebook and comparative analysis on determinants and effects of digital technology uptake.	Jan. 2020–Apr. 2020

Course Assistant, graduate public policy courses, Brown

University — Providence, RI

Jun. 2020–Dec. 2020

Supported graduate courses in Microeconomics, Statistics, and Policymaking in Comparative Perspective through grading, office hours, and class-material preparation.

PRESENTATIONS

Second-Year Paper Presentation Cornell University, 2026.

Presented “What are the Labor Market Effects of U.S. State-Level R&D Tax Credits?” to peers and faculty.

World Bank–IMF Annual Meetings 2022.

Presented analysis related to the global food crisis, commodity price shocks, and IMF policy response.

SERVICE AND ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Vice President, Graduate Student Association for Economics,

Cornell University — Ithaca, NY

2025–2026

Contributed to leadership and community-building efforts, including organizing the student works-in-progress seminar and conducting outreach with prospective students.

Academic participation

Regularly attend the macro-lunch seminar, Macroeconomics Workshop, and Labor Workshop.

Participate in a student-led reading group on structural labor economics.

SKILLS

Programming and empirical tools: Stata, R, Python, Excel; panel data construction, event studies, differences-in-differences, local projections, machine learning and text analysis.

Languages: English (native), Italian (native), French (intermediate), Spanish (intermediate).